

TEHO CONSULTING

GOUSTO (SCA INVESTMENTS LIMITED)

Opportunity Report – Executive Summary

DATE

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ANALYST

Teho Consulting AI Advisory Team

BUSINESS

Gousto (SCA Investments Limited)

REPORT DEPTH

Executive Summary

Executive Snapshot

Gousto is a leading UK meal kit provider, specialising in subscription and one-off meal boxes with over 200 weekly recipes, supported by ambient and chilled grocery add-ons via its Gousto Market. Founded in 2012 and headquartered in Shepherd's Bush, London, Gousto operates four automated fulfilment centres, delivering approximately 8 million meals monthly. The company reported revenues of £312m and an adjusted EBITDA of £42m for FY2024 (S1), with around 1,600 employees across HQ and fulfilment sites (LinkedIn Oct 2025). Gousto's mission is to "reinvent the evening meal" by making home cooking more joyful, convenient, and sustainable.

Despite strong growth and operational automation (140% throughput improvement at Warrington site, S2), Gousto faces persistent challenges. Customer feedback highlights frequent courier delays, missing ingredients, and produce quality issues, which drive refund credits and make-good vouchers estimated at £16m annually, materially impacting margins (S3). Menu complexity with 200 recipes weekly adds pressure on procurement and packaging, complicating supply chain and inventory management. Gousto's tech stack includes an in-house Factory API, AWS infrastructure, Snowflake data platform, and customer engagement tools like Braze and Zendesk, providing a solid foundation for AI integration.

Current revenue and margin pressures suggest an AI-driven opportunity in the £10m–£25m annual value range, primarily through operational efficiencies, improved customer experience, and reduced waste (assumption based on refund credit impact and throughput gains). Data gaps remain on customer support contact volumes and exact cost-to-serve metrics, warranting further internal analysis.

Top three AI wins

1. Reducing delivery delays and damaged boxes

Problem: Courier delays and damaged goods frequently cited in Trustpilot reviews (S3), leading to customer churn and refund costs (~£16m annually).

AI fix: Predictive delivery routing and real-time exception management using courier telemetry and weather/traffic data to optimise last-mile logistics.

Upside: £5m–£10m annual savings from reduced refunds, improved retention, and lower customer service costs (assumption based on refund credit spend and SLA improvements).

2. Optimising menu complexity and procurement

Problem: Managing 200+ weekly recipes strains procurement and packaging lines, increasing waste and operational costs (S1, S3).

AI fix: Demand forecasting and recipe optimisation algorithms to streamline ingredient sourcing, reduce waste, and balance menu variety with operational capacity.

Upside: £3m–£7m annual margin improvement through waste reduction and procurement efficiencies (based on <1% food waste and refund credit impact).

3. Enhancing personalised customer engagement

Problem: Heavy reliance on referral codes and influencer marketing with limited personalisation reduces customer lifetime value and increases acquisition costs.

AI fix: Advanced customer segmentation and recommendation engines leveraging order history, meal ratings, and pause/resume behaviour to boost retention and upsell.

Upside: £2m–£8m uplift in revenue via improved customer loyalty and higher average order value (assumption based on subscription commerce benchmarks).

Cost of waiting

- Continued refund credit spend (~£16m annually) will erode margins and limit reinvestment capacity.
- Competitors like HelloFresh and Mindful Chef are accelerating AI-driven supply chain and customer experience improvements, risking market share loss.
- Operational inefficiencies from menu complexity and delivery issues may increase as volumes scale, raising costs disproportionately.

Unlock the full briefing

The full report includes a detailed AI impact/effort matrix, five deep dives on supply chain, customer experience, marketing, fulfilment automation, and data governance. It also features a competitor AI adoption scan, a phased AI roadmap tailored to Gousto's tech stack, and governance recommendations to ensure ethical and compliant AI deployment.

Recommended next step

Initiate a focused AI pilot project targeting delivery exception prediction and customer refund reduction. Teho Consulting can support with rapid prototyping, data integration, and stakeholder alignment. Contact us at teho.ai to schedule a discovery workshop and unlock Gousto's AI potential.